

Chapter 12

On this night, Yin Lingzhu completely understood that to Yan Si, she was just someone who could be there or not.

Whether she was there or not, it didn't matter at all.

Since that was the case, why should she continue to desperately cling to Yan Si?

This year's time, she would just consider it as feeding the dogs¹, just consider it the consequence of her poor judgment of people.

The sun gradually rose, and after the rain, the air became fresh.

After sobering up, Yin Lingzhu calculated the money Yan Si had spent on her.

Once she returned this money to Yan Si, she and Yan Si would have no relationship anymore.

"What are your plans next?" Ji Jingrong was very happy about Yin Lingzhu's change and asked.

Yin Lingzhu answered without hesitation, "Go to the company, make money, debut!"

She had really wanted to go to that concert before, but because of Yan Si, she didn't go.

Now that she didn't need to consider Yan Si, of course she wanted to pursue her dream.

Ji Jingrong's eyes lit up when she heard her answer.

If Yin Lingzhu really let go, did that mean she could pursue her?

However, she didn't plan to be too obvious about it. Yin Lingzhu had just ended a failed marriage, so she probably wouldn't be ready to accept a new romance now.

Ji Jingrong had liked Yin Lingzhu for a long time.

In that alley, the moment Yin Lingzhu blocked the stick for her, she knew she was moved.

From childhood to adulthood, Ji Jingrong had never been chosen.

She had climbed up step by step from a small place, and everyone thought she was strong, defaulting to the assumption that she didn't need protection.

Ji Jingrong had always thought so too, but when she saw that slender figure blocking in front of her, she clearly felt her heart beating.

Maybe it was the suspension bridge effect², but she really did fall for Yin Lingzhu at that moment.

"I support you, go do what you like." Ji Jingrong said with a smile.

"Thank you for staying with me all this time."

Yin Lingzhu was very grateful for Ji Jingrong's companionship during this period.

"Who told us we're friends." Ji Jingrong said, "Let's go, set off toward your new life."

Yin Lingzhu walked into the company, preparing to find her agent to discuss plans.

Before she could react, someone suddenly came out and pulled her along. After Yin Lingzhu came to her senses, she obediently followed.

It was her agent.

"You finally came." The agent pulled Yin Lingzhu into the studio.

"Hurry up and look at your Weibo³."

Yin Lingzhu looked at her phone in confusion - it was dead.

She shook her phone at her agent, Yang Daiyi, "No battery."

"Your Weibo exploded." Yang Daiyi handed her phone to Yin Lingzhu for her to see clearly.

The concert held on Yin Lingzhu's birthday had unexpectedly gone viral, and some people followed the timeline and found the previous concert.

Although Yin Lingzhu hadn't participated in this recent one, she had participated in the previous one.

Therefore, Yin Lingzhu's previous performance was dug up.

Some people were attracted by Yin Lingzhu's singing and found their way to Yin Lingzhu's Weibo.

Yin Lingzhu's Weibo was managed by her agent.

Because of Yan Si, she could basically only come to the company one day.

So her Weibo had pitifully little content, just some selfies and a few short videos of her singing without accompaniment.

In the videos, Yin Lingzhu looked very green, with slight nervousness on her face, lips slightly pursed, jaw tense, eyes focused on the lyrics in her hands.

Although Yin Lingzhu's Weibo had pitifully little content, the fans attracted to her were eagerly waiting for more in the comments.

Wave after wave of people were attracted, fans kept accumulating, so she actually had over a hundred thousand followers.

This number of followers wasn't impressive for popular traffic stars, but for a nobody with nothing, this amount was very high.

"So, you need to take advantage of this opportunity to increase your follower count." Yang Daiyi's tone was excited.

She was just a small agent who had never managed anyone particularly popular.

Now that a potentially popular prospect suddenly appeared, Yang Daiyi definitely had to seize the opportunity.

"First practice this song well, and post it to Weibo when you're proficient." Yang Daiyi selected a song with the highest popularity for Yin Lingzhu to practice.

"There's another concert in a few days, I'll find a way to get you on stage." After Yang Daiyi finished speaking, she hurriedly left.

This was the advantage of big companies - lots of activities, which was a rare opportunity for people at the bottom.

Yin Lingzhu took her phone and started browsing comments.

Thanks to her not being very famous yet, all her comments were friendly, mostly people praising her looks.

Yin Lingzhu practiced in the studio all morning and posted her results to Weibo.

Yin Lingzhu didn't expect that as soon as she posted it, someone commented.

【Fresh video, sisters come quickly!】 This account tagged a bunch of people.

Yin Lingzhu replied to this comment.

【Thank you for your support】

Yin Lingzhu wanted to say more, but Yang Daiyi came back.

"There's a dinner party tonight, come with me. The person in charge of the concert will be there."

Yang Daiyi spoke, but her face didn't show any happy expression.

"Many people will come to this dinner, you must be extra careful."

The opportunity for this dinner party was something she had traded with another resource she had.

She hoped Yin Lingzhu wouldn't disappoint her.

She looked at Yin Lingzhu - the person in front of her really had a kind of spiritual energy.

"Practice hard. If tonight is successful, this song will be what you'll sing." After Yang Daiyi finished speaking, she hurried off again.

Maybe all agents were this busy.

She wondered what Yan Si's agent was like. At her level, her agent must be very worried.

Yin Lingzhu's face stiffened - why was she thinking about Yan Si again?

This past year, thinking about Yan Si had become a habit.

Yin Lingzhu shook her head, shaking Yan Si out of her mind, and began to practice the song wholeheartedly.

All day, Yin Lingzhu stayed in the studio.

When night fell, Yang Daiyi brought her to the restaurant.

"You don't need to worry, you just need to go in and sit down."

"I'll handle everything else."

Yang Daiyi and Yin Lingzhu got out of the car, but didn't go directly into the restaurant.

At the entrance, she gave Yin Lingzhu a bunch of instructions. Seeing Yin Lingzhu nod obediently, she finally felt at ease.

While listening to Yang Daiyi's warnings, Yin Lingzhu noticed someone spying on her from the shadows.

She looked in that direction but didn't see anyone. Since she didn't sense any malice, Yin Lingzhu didn't take it to heart.

Yang Daiyi brought Yin Lingzhu to a private room on the second floor.

The moment the door opened, Yin Lingzhu smelled a choking odor - a mixture of cigarettes, alcohol, and strawberry scent.

Why would there be a strawberry scent?

Yin Lingzhu found it strange but didn't ask. She followed behind Yang Daiyi, listening to Yang Daiyi's arrangements.

This concert wasn't high-level, so the person in charge actually didn't have a very noble status.

Yang Daiyi said a bunch of nice things at the drinking table, pouring alcohol into her stomach.

Yin Lingzhu observed the people in the private room.

Before they arrived, there were already three people in the private room.

Two men, one wearing glasses, one not, both with buzz cuts. It seemed one of them should be the person in charge.

The other person was a young girl with loose hair, looking soft and weak. Because her head was lowered, her appearance wasn't clear.

Yin Lingzhu glanced around and then withdrew her gaze, quietly eating the food in front of her.

"Just drink this bottle, and I'll let your little artist participate." The man with glasses took out a bottle of beer and said to Yang Daiyi.

Yin Lingzhu looked at the unopened bottle - under the orange-yellow lights, it appeared crystal clear and looked very harmless.

Turning her gaze to Yang Daiyi, she found that Yang Daiyi was in a very bad state, her face already covered with a red flush, and her eyes becoming unfocused.

Yin Lingzhu took the bottle into her own hands, "She's my agent, I'll drink it for her."

Without listening to what the person in charge said, she directly opened the bottle cap and started drinking.

Everyone's gaze settled on Yin Lingzhu.

In the bottle, the liquid decreased at a visible rate.

"Is that enough?" Yin Lingzhu turned the bottle mouth downward - not a single drop of alcohol fell out.

Her eyes stared at the person in charge.

The person in charge originally wanted to say that it was useless even if Yin Lingzhu drank it.

But when he made eye contact with Yin Lingzhu, he couldn't say anything.

Being stared at by Yin Lingzhu, he seemed to feel Alpha pressure. He was A-level, so for him to feel pressure, her level must be even higher.

Although the person in charge didn't believe it, he didn't object.

He could reach his current position by relying on his eye for people.

"No problem, Little Yin, right? Very good, very good. You practice the songs, you'll definitely be able to perform at the concert." The person in charge said with a face full of smiles, fawning over her.

Yin Lingzhu said thank you and helped Yang Daiyi out.

After leaving the private room, Yin Lingzhu discovered there was another person following behind them.

It was that young girl.

"Can, can you take me with you?" Her head was still lowered, her tone full of pleading.

Yin Lingzhu originally wanted to refuse - she didn't know this person - but Yang Daiyi suddenly spoke up.

"You seem to be Old Li's artist, right? Old Li mentioned you to me, I remember you." Yang Daiyi said with slurred speech.

It seemed Yang Daiyi knew her.

If they left her in the private room, the person in charge was obviously not a good person, and who knows what the consequences would be.

Yin Lingzhu nodded, "Then come with us."

Back in the car, Yin Lingzhu felt her head becoming dizzy and her body gradually losing strength.

It seemed that bottle had been tampered with.

She had drunk alcohol, and in her current condition, she couldn't drive.

She didn't know if that young girl had a driver's license either.

Yin Lingzhu put Yang Daiyi in the back seat and called for a designated driver⁴.

While waiting for the designated driver, she originally wanted to ask Yang Daiyi where she lived, but Yang Daiyi was too drunk, and Yin Lingzhu couldn't get an answer.

Yin Lingzhu then asked the young girl, but she shook her head and wouldn't say anything.

Yin Lingzhu had no choice. When the designated driver arrived, she told him the name of a hotel.

This hotel was where she was temporarily staying.

Yin Lingzhu booked three rooms, sent Yang Daiyi and the young girl to their rooms, then returned to her own room.

Her gaze fell on her phone - there were missed calls from Yan Si.

Dozens of them, seemingly starting from when she was at the dinner party, but her phone had been on silent, so she didn't hear them.

Yin Lingzhu blacklisted Yan Si's phone number and deleted all contact methods.

She was now unwilling to have even the slightest connection with Yan Si.

On the other side, Yan Si stared at two surveillance monitors, listening to the busy tone on the phone, her heart filled with anger, and beneath that anger was a trace of fear.

Footnotes:

¹ **Feeding the dogs** (喂狗): A Chinese expression meaning to waste something valuable on someone unworthy, similar to "casting pearls before swine."

² **Suspension bridge effect**: A psychological phenomenon where people might misinterpret fear-induced arousal as romantic attraction when in a dangerous or exciting situation.

³ **Weibo**: China's equivalent of Twitter, a popular social media platform.

⁴ **Designated driver** (代駕): A service common in China where a professional driver drives you and your car home when you're unable to drive, usually after drinking.

